

SIMATS ENGINEERING (SAVEETHA SCHOOL OF ENGINEERING)

Department of Artificial Intelligence and Data Science

ASSESSMENT TOOL 3 – CODING CHALLENGE

Course Code:	DSA03	Course Title:	Natural Language Processing
CO Assessed:	CO1 – Imitation (L1)	Assessment:	Assessment Tool 3 – Coding Challenge
Weightage:	30% of CIA		
CO5 Statement:	Analyse NLP models, regular expression patterns, finite state automata, morphological processing techniques and to interpret language processing. (BL-3)		
Student Name:	Vasanthan Nithi D Y	Reg. No.:	192424137
Section / Batch:	2024	Date:	27-07-2026

Code of Conduct

I Vasanthan Nithi D Y (Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment. I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will result in disciplinary action.

Signature of the Student: _____

Instructions

- Develop a complete and modular Python program that meets all the functional requirements specified in the coding challenge using appropriate algorithms, data structures, and programming practices.
- Test the program using multiple valid and invalid test cases, and clearly display the input, processing, and output to verify the correctness of the implementation.
- Follow standard coding practices by using meaningful variable names, proper indentation, comments, exception handling (where applicable), and upload the source code, sample outputs, and README file to the designated GitHub repository.
- Duration: 40 minutes.

Section / Topic	Focus	Q Nos
Porter Stemmer	class design, methods, encapsulation, and rule-based stemming	1

Annexure A – Coding Challenge

Section 1: Object-Oriented Implementation of a Porter Stemmer

You have recently joined an **NLP startup** called **LexiMind Technologies**. The company is developing a **search engine** for a digital library containing millions of research papers. Users expect the search engine to return relevant results even when different grammatical forms of a word are used.

For example, a search for **connect** should also retrieve documents containing **connected**, **connecting**, **connection**, and **connections**. To achieve this, the development team has decided to implement the **Porter Stemming Algorithm** from scratch.

Since the algorithm consists of multiple sequential rules (Step 1a, Step 1b, Step 1c, Step 2, Step 3, Step 4, Step 5a, and Step 5b), the project manager has divided the work among team members. Each developer is responsible for implementing and testing one specific rule. At the end of the project, all modules must be integrated into a single, fully functional stemmer.

Assessment Task

Phase 1: Individual Task (Assigned Rule)

Each student will be assigned **one Porter Stemmer rule**.

Your responsibilities are to:

1. Study and understand the assigned rule.
2. Explain the linguistic purpose of the rule.
3. Describe the conditions under which the rule should be applied.
4. Implement the rule in Python.
5. Prepare at least **10 test words** demonstrating:
 - Words that satisfy the rule.
 - Words that should remain unchanged.
6. Document the input, expected output, and actual output.
7. Explain any limitations or special cases encountered.

Phase 2: Team Integration

As a team, integrate all individual rule implementations into a complete Porter Stemmer.

The team must:

- Arrange the rules in the correct execution order.
- Resolve conflicts between rule implementations.
- Ensure that the output of one rule becomes the input to the next rule.
- Test the complete algorithm using at least **50 different English words**.
- Compare the team's results with the NLTK Porter Stemmer.
- Identify and explain any differences.

Phase 3: Reflection

Prepare a report addressing the following questions:

1. Why is the order of Porter Stemmer rules important?
2. What errors would occur if your assigned rule were skipped?
3. How did integrating multiple rules improve stemming accuracy?
4. Which rule was the most challenging to implement and why?
5. What improvements would you suggest for the Porter Stemming algorithm?

Rubrics for Calculation

Criteria	Weightage	Level 4 – Exemplary	Level 3 – Proficient	Level 2 – Developing	Level 1 – Beginning
Problem Understanding	20%	Clearly understands problem constraints, edge cases, and competitive requirements	Understands problem with minor gaps in constraints	Partial understanding; misses key constraints	Misinterprets problem or constraints
Algorithm	25%	Selects optimal algorithm with best time and space complexity for competitive constraints	Uses efficient algorithm with minor scope for improvement	Uses basic/inefficient approach	No clear algorithmic approach

Code Implementation	20%	Writes correct, efficient, and clean code that passes all constraints	Code works with minor errors or inefficiencies	Partially correct code; fails for some cases	Code does not execute or gives incorrect results
Competitive Performance	20%	Solves problem within time limits and handles large inputs effectively	Solves within acceptable time with minor delays	Struggles with time limits or larger inputs	Unable to solve within time constraints
Test Case Handling	15%	Handles all test cases including edge and hidden cases	Handles most test cases	Misses important edge cases	Fails on multiple test cases

Q. No. / Criteria	Problem Understanding	Algorithm	Code Implementation	Competitive Performance	Test Case Handling	Sub. Total	Total %
1							
2							
3							

Faculty In-charge	Course Coordinator	Program Director
Dr.T.Kumaragurubaran		
Signature: _____	Signature: _____	Signature: _____
Date: _____	Date: _____	Date: _____

Implementation of Porter Stemmer – Step 2

2. Objective

To implement **Step 2** of the Porter Stemming Algorithm by replacing specific suffixes with shorter forms after checking the measure (m) condition.

3. Theory

Step 2 of the Porter Stemmer replaces common suffixes such as "**ational**", "**tional**", "**izer**", etc., with simpler suffixes. Before replacing the suffix, the algorithm checks whether the stem satisfies **$m > 0$** , ensuring that only valid stems are modified.

4. Algorithm

1. Read the input word.
2. Check whether the word ends with a Step 2 suffix.
3. Extract the stem by removing the suffix.
4. Calculate the measure (m) of the stem.
5. If $m > 0$, replace the suffix with its corresponding replacement.
6. Otherwise, leave the word unchanged.
7. Display the resulting word.
8. Stop.

5. Python Program

Measure Function

```
def measure(stem):
```

```
    vowels = "aeiou"
```

```
    m = 0
```

```
    previous = False
```

```
    for ch in stem:
```

```
    if ch in vowels:
        previous = True
```

```
elif previous:
    m += 1
    previous = False
```

```
return m
```

Example Step 2 Rule

```
def replace_ational(word):

    if word.endswith("ational"):

        stem = word[:-7]

        if measure(stem) > 0:
            return stem + "ate"

    return word
```

6. Sample Input and Output

Input	Output
relational	relate
celebrational	celebrate
conditional	condition
operational	operate
book	book

7. Result

The Step 2 suffix replacement rule was implemented successfully. Words satisfying the suffix and $m > 0$ condition were stemmed correctly, while other words remained unchanged.

8. Conclusion

Step 2 improves stemming by replacing longer suffixes with standardized forms. This helps different grammatical forms of a word map to a common stem, improving text processing and search efficiency.